



6 GOOGLE INDIA TOP ATTRIBUTES

- FAIR AND OBJECTIVE PROCESSES AND POLICIES
- GROWTH AND LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES
- WORKLOAD AND FLEXIBILITY AT WORK

◀ **EMPOWERING EMPLOYEES** Shradhdhanjali Rao, Head of HR, Google India

THE FLEXIBILITY TO EXCEL

By offering employees multiple ways by which they can work and grow, Google has ensured that it gets the best from them

BY NIDHI SINGAL

WHAT DO THE employees of a company that provides answers to practically everything search for? Like other professionals, they too are looking for a workplace culture that values respect and has avenues for personal growth. What is the answer of the company (it's Google in case you haven't guessed it already) for them? For Google India, it is flexibility in their approach towards how (and where) employees work. And there's a simple reason why Google is doing it.

"For two decades, India has been the crucible where Google's innovation has thrived. We've grown our presence across five cities and created a workplace and culture for India's best talent to develop many of our global solutions with India's unique needs at the forefront," says Sanjay Gupta, Country

Head & Vice President of Google India.

Driven by this, Google offers customised development opportunities to employees (called Googlers), which ranges from formal programmes to informal learning through projects and cross-functional collaborations. For instance, full-time employees are eligible for the '20% Projects' programme that lets them dedicate up to 20% of their work time to pursue side projects of their choice.

"This fosters creativity, experimentation, and skill development, ultimately benefitting both the individual Googler and the company as a whole," says Google India's Head of HR Shradhdhanjali Rao.

While these initiatives give employees opportunities to explore beyond their existing role or put their expertise to use within the company, Google also encourages them to keep learning. "Under the Educational Reimbursement programme, we offer \$3,500 annually to eligible Googlers across all levels in India to participate in personal or business-critical courses to directly improve a skill outside of what's offered at Google," explains Rao.

While many organisations are increasingly focussing on gender equality and inclusion, Google has gone a step further. "We also take concrete steps to reduce bias systematically. For instance, our hiring

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